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Last update: October 28, 2026.

Research Interests

Broad Semantics, Syntax, Pragmatics, and their interfaces; Language acquisition, Psycholinguistics

Narrow Indefinites, Question, Disjunction, Modality, Presupposition, Anaphora, Sinitic languages (Mandarin, Wu, & Cantonese, and more)

Education

2024-29 *(expected)* **The University of Maryland, College Park** (UMD) — *College Park, MD*
Ph.D. Student in Linguistics
Advisors: Alexander Williams and Aron Hirsch

2017-22 **The Chinese University of Hong Kong** (CUHK) — *Hong Kong*
Major in Linguistics (Minor in Japanese Language), Bachelor of Arts (1st Hons.)

Publications & Proceedings

NB: *first author; {co-first authors}

2026 **Shi, M. G.** (*in prep.*). Restricting the semantics of interrogative disjunctors. *Proceedings of the Amsterdam Colloquium 2026 (AC 2026).*

2026 **Shi, M. G.** (2026). Restricting ignorance. In G. Correa & K. Morand (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 56th Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistics Society (NELS 56)* (Vol. 3, pp. 101—110). GLSA. **[full-text available]**

2024 **Shi, G.*** & Pan, H. (2024). Focus, QUD, and existential *wh*-indefinites in Mandarin. In T. S. Kim (Ed.), *Proceedings of the 25th Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar (SICOGG 25)* (pp. 227-244). **[full-text available]**

2023 **Shi, M. G.** (2023). Where is the retained object in indirect passives, and what is its Case? Evidence from object fronting phenomena in Wu Chinese. In T. S. Kim & J. Kang (Eds.), *Proceedings of The 24th Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar (SICOGG 24)* (pp. 141-165). **[full-text available]**

Presentations

NB: *first author; {co-first authors}

Conference Presentations

2026 **Shi, M. G.** (Dec 2026). Restricting the semantics of interrogative disjunctors. Talk to be given at the Amsterdam Colloquium 2026. Amsterdam, Netherlands.

Shi, M. G. (Oct 2026). Restricting the semantics of interrogative disjunctors. Poster given at The 12th Mid-Atlantic Colloquium of Studies in Meaning (MACSIM 12). Rutgers, New Brunswick, NJ. **[poster available]**(NON-PEER-REVIEWED)

2025 **Shi, M. G.***, & Pan, H. (Dec 2025). Ungrammatical or infelicitous? Licensing condition for Mandarin *wh*-indefinites. Talk given at The 4th International Conference on Formal Approaches to Meaning in Chinese (ICFAMC 4). CUHK, Hong Kong.

Shi, M. G. (Oct 2025). Restricting ignorance. Poster given at The 56th Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistics Society (NELS 56). NYU, New York. **[poster available]**

Shi, M. G. (Oct 2025). Restricting ignorance. Poster given at The 11th Mid-Atlantic Colloquium of Studies in Meaning (MACSIM 11). JHU, Baltimore, MD (NON-PEER-REVIEWED)

{Zumchak, W., Tang, C., **Shi, M. G.**, Laun, A., Chakraborty, A.}, & Lau, E. (Sept 2025). The role of contextual information in auditory perception: Investigating N400 effects under speech degradation. Poster given as part of the Sandbox Series at The 17th Annual Meeting of the Society for the Neurobiology of Language (SNL 2025). Gallaudet University, Washington DC.

2024 **Shi, M. G.***, Wu, H., Lam, G. Y., Kang, X., Wong, P. C. M., & Geng, X. (Oct 2024). The role of language comprehension ability on anxiety in autistic and typically-developing children. Poster given at The 16th Annual Meeting of the Society for the Neurobiology of Language (SNL 2024). Brisbane, Australia.

2023 **Shi, G.***, Yang, C. L., & Pan, H. (Dec 2023). Reflexive reference resolution in Mandarin: An eye-tracking study. Poster given at Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP) Asia 2023. CUHK, Hong Kong. **[poster available]**

Shi, G.* & Pan, H. (Aug 2023). Focus, QUD, and existential *wh*-indefinites in Mandarin. Poster given at The 25th Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar (SICOGG 25). Dongguk University, Seoul: South Korea. **[poster available]**

2022 **Shi, G.** (Aug 2022). Where is the retained object in indirect passives, and what is its Case? Evidence from object fronting phenomena in Wu Chinese. Talk given at The 24th Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar (SICOGG 24). Sogang University, Seoul: South Korea (Online).

OTHER SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

2024 **Shi, M. G.**, (Nov 2024). Where does ignorance come from? Talk given at UMD Meaning Meeting. University of Maryland, College Park.

Teaching Experience (University of Maryland)

2026(F) **LING 410 Grammar and Meaning**

Duty: Provide detailed feedback on individual coursework via grading and holding small in-class discussions, and hold office hours.

Instructor: Prof. Valentine Hacquard

2026(S) **LING 240 Language and Mind**

Duty: Grade and provide detailed feedback on individual coursework, and hold office hours.

Instructor: Dr. Tonia Bleam

2025(F) **LING 200 Introduction to Linguistics**

Duty: Lead weekly discussion section, design and prepare course materials, grade and provide detailed feedback on individual coursework, and hold office hours.

Instructor: Dr. Margaret Antonisse

Awards & Scholarships

2025 General Institute Fellowship for LSA Summer Institute (University of Oregon), LSA

2024– Dean's Fellowship, Department of Linguistics, UMD

2024– Graduate Assistantship, Department of Linguistics, UMD

2019-22 Dean's List Awards (2019/20-2021/22), Faculty of Arts, CUHK

2021 S.H. Ho College Annual Scholarships for Outstanding Academic Performance, CUHK

2017 Full-tuition Admission Scholarships (Mainland China), CUHK

Selected Non-Degree Education

2025 The LSA Summer Institute
University of Oregon (7 Jul - 9 Aug)

2022-24 The 4-9th NYI Global Institute of Cultural, Cognitive, and Linguistic Studies (V-NYI)
Held online

Services

2026- Maryland Linguistics Colloquium
Organizing committee *UMD, MD*

2026- Journal *FLaP FIRST*
Vol. 3 editor *Hong Kong*

2025- S(yntax)-Lab
Co-organizer *UMD, MD*

2025- The Forum on Cantonese Linguistics (FoCaL)
Organizing Committee *Hong Kong*

2025- Dean's Graduate Advisory Board, College of Arts & Humanities
Representative, Linguistics *UMD, MD*

2025 Mayfest 2025 - Constraints on Meaning (16-17 May)
Organizing Committee *UMD, MD*

2023 The 2nd International Symposium on Formal Approaches to Meaning in Chinese (ISFAMC) (20-23 Jun)
Coordinator *CUHK, Hong Kong*

2022-24 S.H. Ho College, The Chinese University of Hong Kong
Resident Tutor *Hong Kong*

Employment

08/2024– Department of Linguistics, UMD *College Park, MD*
Graduate Assistant

01-07/2024 Brain and Mind Institute (BMI), CUHK *Hong Kong*
Research Assistant (PI: Xiujuan Geng)

2022-23 Laboratory of Theoretical Psycholinguistics (LTP), CUHK *Hong Kong*
Research Assistant (PI: Haihua Pan)

Skills

Language	**Native**: Mandarin & Linhai Wu; **Fluent**: English & Cantonese; **Intermediate**: Japanese.
Software	R, Python, LaTeX.
Experiment techniques	Experiment Builder & Data Viewer (*SR Research*), EyeLink 1000 Plus (*SR Research*); EEG (*EGI*), E-Prime 2; Qualtrics; Praat.

Professional Affiliation

2024–	Linguistic Society of America (LSA)
2023–	Generative Linguistics in the Old World (GLOW)